

ANSWER KEY

DSAT_Dec_2024_US_1-W

Adaptive Digital SAT Practice Test — Original Composition

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Section 1: Reading and Writing — Module 1

Q1. A) contributions to

The fellowship honors exceptional artists, so Black was chosen for her lifetime "contributions to" the arts. The other options (objections, departures, confusions) are negative or illogical in context.

Q2. C) Enjoying

"Savoring" means taking pleasure in or enjoying something. Jo is relishing the crisp air after finishing her manuscript. Ignoring, distributing, and evaluating don't capture the sense of appreciative enjoyment.

Q3. B) participation

Johnson argues adaptation requires the "active" involvement of vulnerable communities. "Participation" fits the idea of active engagement. Withdrawal is the opposite; documentation and reduction don't match "active" involvement.

Q4. A) dynamic

The passage describes constant change: shifting sandbars, fluctuating bird populations, and expanding/contracting area. "Dynamic" means characterized by constant change. Isolated, uniform, and predictable contradict the described variability.

Q5. C) It defines a concept central to the text's discussion of shoegaze.

The underlined sentence defines "subgenre" before the text discusses shoegaze as an example. It provides a definitional foundation for the discussion that follows.

Q6. D) It offers an analogy intended to clarify the nature of the owl study.

The comparison to submarine sonar is an analogy helping readers understand how the sound-playback method works. It doesn't identify a flaw, contrast studies, or describe a technology the researchers actually adapted.

Q7. B) The clades to which they belong originated no earlier than 21 million years ago.

Text 2 shows the oldest crown age on Madagascar is 21 million years (baobabs), with most clades much younger. The author of Text 2 would agree that ancestral lineages' clades originated no earlier than ~21 million years ago.

Q8. B) Agencies managing aquatic resources should direct more conservation effort toward the freshwater mussel than toward the channel catfish.

Text 1 states the mussel is threatened while the catfish can withstand warming. Text 2 says agencies must prioritize the most threatened species. Both would agree the mussel deserves more conservation focus.

Q9. D) She is impatient for the gathering to end so she can restore the room.

Beatrice checks multiple times whether guests have left. The room is her "private sanctuary" where she arranges figurines and reads. She wants to reclaim it. There's no evidence she finds guests offensive, wants to announce plans, or needs the room for a priest.

Q10. C) dandelion and the black-eyed Susan.

A negative interaction index means the companion reduced pollinator visits. Dandelion (−0.7218) and black-eyed Susan (−0.5904) both have negative values. White clover (0.3142) and goldenrod (0.2865) are positive.

Q11. C) "There are things in that paper that nobody knows but me..."

The claim is that the narrator experiences the wallpaper as a form of liberation from confinement. Option C shows her finding something private and meaningful in the pattern—a secret world separate from her restriction. The other quotes describe her confinement or husband, not liberation through the wallpaper.

Q12. C) Increased pupil dilation, an established indicator of focused concentration, was not observed during the sonata.

The critic argues the reduced heart rate indicates deep focus, not relaxation. If pupil dilation (a known focus indicator) was absent during the sonata, that would undermine the claim that students were deeply concentrating.

Q13. D) Alloy K5 has the same chromium percentage as Alloy K3 but a lower tensile strength.

K3 and K5 both contain 18.00% chromium, yet their tensile strengths are 287 MPa and 254 MPa, respectively. This directly shows that chromium percentage alone does not determine tensile strength.

Q14. C) may be critical to the ongoing survival of threatened hardwood species such as the koa tree.

The passage states koa survival depends on bird seed dispersal, native birds are gone, but non-native birds now transport koa seeds. The logical conclusion is that these non-native birds may be essential for the koa's continued survival.

Q15. A) ear,

The sentence lists three parallel items: the outer ear, middle, and inner ear. A comma after 'ear' correctly separates the first item from the rest of the series.

Q16. D) Americans who held office

No apostrophe is needed because "Americans" is simply a plural noun, not possessive. The sentence says Campbell was one of the Americans who held office. No possession is being indicated.

Q17. D) 1957; Python, created by Guido van Rossum in 1991; and Ruby

This is a complex list where items contain internal commas (dates, creator names). Semicolons are used to separate items in a list when the items themselves contain commas. The appositive 'created by Guido van Rossum in 1991' is set off by commas within the semicolon-separated list.

Q18. B) they're

"They're" = "they are." The sentence says these languages, because they are descendants of Proto-Bantu, can reveal details. "Its" and "it's" are singular. "Their" is possessive, which doesn't fit grammatically here.

Q19. D) In fact,

The first sentence says the language was seldom used for literature until the poet championed it. The next sentence provides intensifying evidence (2,000+ words). "In fact" introduces information that strengthens or elaborates on the previous claim. "However" and "On the contrary" indicate contrast, which is wrong here.

Q20. C) For this reason,

The 900 is described as so rare that every execution is historic. The next sentence says fans have revered those who performed it. "For this reason" logically connects the rarity/significance to the reverence. "Regardless" would dismiss the preceding point.

Q21. C) Indeed,

The first sentence says distinguishing the two species can challenge experts. "Indeed" affirms and expands on this claim by explaining why: the species share similarities that make them look nearly identical. "Instead" and "Thus" don't fit the affirming relationship.

Q22. A) The self-portrait *The Broken Column* was created by Kahlo in 1944.

The goal is to provide an example of a Kahlo self-portrait. Choice A names a specific work (*The Broken Column*), identifies it as a self-portrait, and gives the year. Choice C names a painting but doesn't specify it's a self-portrait. B and D don't provide a specific example.

Q23. C) Both the Thomas Point Shoal Light and the Ambrose Lightship served as navigational aids along the eastern United States coast.

The goal is to emphasize a similarity. Choice C identifies something both share: they served as navigational aids on the eastern coast. D emphasizes a difference (different harbors). A and B discuss only one of the two.

Q24. D) The Foucault pendulum at the University of Bologna in Italy features a wire that is approximately 22 meters long.

The goal is to specify the wire's length. Only D includes the specific measurement (22 meters). A, B, and C omit the length entirely.

Q25. A) With 32.4 percent of its population under eighteen, Peru has the twenty-ninth-largest population in that age range worldwide.

The goal is to emphasize Peru's global rank. Only A includes both the percentage (32.4%) and the specific rank (twenty-ninth). B, C, and D focus on other aspects or on Latin America generally.

Q26. D) contend

The subject is "behavioral economists like Thaler" (plural). A plural subject requires the base form "contend," not "contends" (singular) or "has contended" (singular). "Is contending" is also singular.

Q27. A) ranger Pranab Das

"Pranab Das" is an essential appositive identifying which ranger, so no commas are needed. When the appositive is necessary to specify the noun (there could be multiple rangers), it should not be set off by commas.

Section 1: Reading and Writing — Module 2 Easier

Q1. B) highlighted

The exhibition was curated to show the artistry of clothing traditions. "Highlighted" means drew attention to or showcased. Concealed, undermined, and delayed are negative or don't fit.

Q2. C) resilient

Quinoa thrives at high altitudes and in poor soils, demonstrating toughness and adaptability. "Resilient" means able to withstand difficult conditions.

Q3. C) generating

Rising prices caused new buyers to enter the market—the price surge created (generated) additional demand. Stabilizing, reducing, and measuring don't capture the causal creation of new demand.

Q4. B) demonstrates

The frequent citation of Chetty's publications shows (demonstrates) that his research is useful. "Contradicts" is the opposite; "prevents" and "overshadows" don't logically fit.

Q5. C) It establishes a key observation leading to the practical application.

The underlined portion notes that temperature drops occur in the air around the lichen. This observation directly inspires the cooling panel described next. It's the bridge between the research finding and the practical application.

Q6. C) It illustrates a phenomenon the text suggests is common but poorly accounted for by the energy ladder.

The Dominican Republic example shows a fuel-use shift that the energy ladder model would explain. The text then presents Guatemala research showing the model is oversimplified. The DR example illustrates the kind of change the energy ladder tries (but fails) to fully explain.

Q7. D) It is attributable to a factor other than proximity.

Bogotá residents used parks more despite living farther from them than Santiago residents. This means proximity alone can't explain the difference—some other factor must be responsible.

Q8. B) When the team played white noise, the crickets showed no defensive response.

If *G. bimaculatus* doesn't respond to random noise but does respond to *E. diurnus* alarm calls, this supports the conclusion that the crickets specifically associate those calls with danger, not just reacting to any sound.

Q9. A) Survey households to rate category similarity, then correlate with purchase probability changes.

The research question is whether perceived category similarity predicts willingness to buy extensions. The study already calculated purchase probability changes. The missing piece is a measure of perceived similarity, which option A provides.

Q10. A) P7's ratings for jazz and classical music would differ from one another.

If P7 gave equal actual ratings to both styles but the correlation between predicted and actual ratings differs (higher for classical than jazz in the graph), the model predicted different enjoyment levels for the two styles—i.e., the predicted ratings would differ.

Q11. D) soil moisture and earthworm density do generally rise and fall together.

Most studies (European and non-European, like Japan) found the positive correlation. Only the Iceland study didn't. The weight of evidence suggests the correlation is real and general, not confined to one region.

Q12. A) the multi-host strategy's advantages may not fully counteract other temperature-related pressures.

Three-host CLPs declined despite being shielded from external conditions during transmission. This suggests that while the transmission strategy offers some protection, it doesn't fully offset other temperature-driven factors affecting CLP abundance.

Q13. D) some bird studies found larger effects than some mammal studies.

The text states that on average mammals showed larger differences, but individual bird studies sometimes exceeded the mammalian average. This means some bird studies found larger effects than some mammal studies.

Q14. C) its

The possessive pronoun "its" refers to the poem's narrative. "It's" = "it is" (wrong here). "Their" and "they're" are plural and don't match the singular poem *Beowulf*.

Q15. C) shade, though

The sentence structure is: 'is a more unusual shade, though deposits of olivine... give the sand a green tint.' A comma before 'though' introduces a concessive clause. No additional punctuation after 'though' is needed before the clause continues.

Q16. B) style: richly,

A colon introduces the list of three hallmarks. The items in the list are separated by semicolons because they contain internal commas. 'style:' sets up the enumeration.

Q17. D) argue

The subject is "development economists like Chang" (plural). The plural subject requires "argue." "Argues" and "has argued" are singular forms. "Is arguing" is also singular.

Q18. A) scientist Dr. Wahyu Raharjo

"Dr. Wahyu Raharjo" is an essential appositive specifying which conservation scientist, so no commas are needed around the name.

Q19. D) released; and

The sentence contains a complex list of key years separated by semicolons (1808...; 1888...; 1930...; 1956...). A semicolon before 'and' is correct for the final item in a semicolon-separated list.

Q20. A) have become

The subject is "many lost plays" (plural), requiring a plural verb. "Have become" is plural. "Becomes," "has become," and "is becoming" are all singular.

Q21. B) Challenging this explanation,

The prior assumption was that barnacles are permanently fixed. The research team found they moved against the current (self-propulsion). This challenges/undermines the assumption, not confirms it.

Q22. C) By contrast,

The JWST is nearly a million miles from Earth, while the Hubble is only 340 miles up. "By contrast" signals the comparison between very different distances.

Q23. C) As such,

The prior sentence states these methods require machines handling thousands of coordinates. The following sentence says they're more cost-effective than hand carving. "As such" connects the technological capability to the cost advantage—because machines handle the complexity, the methods are cheaper than manual work.

Q24. D) That is,

The sentence says the 2023 eclipse "was hybrid" and then explains what hybrid means: some observers saw totality while others saw a ring. "That is" introduces a clarification or definition of the preceding term.

Q25. B) A protected natural area, the Salton Sea NWR encompasses approximately 37,600 acres in California.

The goal is to indicate size. Only B includes the specific acreage (37,600 acres). The other options omit the size entirely.

Q26. D) Because it was built beneath a sandstone overhang, Cliff Palace was naturally shielded from heavy precipitation.

The goal is to explain an advantage of Cliff Palace. D identifies a specific benefit (protection from rain/snow) resulting from its location beneath a rock overhang. The other choices either discuss Bandelier, lack specificity, or don't name the advantage.

Q27. D) Titan's orbit of Saturn is slightly elliptical, illustrating Newton's law... which states that all objects with mass attract one another...

The goal is explanation + example. D provides both: it explains Newton's law (mutual attraction that strengthens with proximity) and gives an example (Titan's elliptical orbit of Saturn).

Section 1: Reading and Writing — Module 2 Harder

Q1. B) surpass

The passage says being first secures a permanent place in memory, and "there is little that can [blank] being the first." The idea is that nothing can exceed or outdo the achievement of being first. "Surpass" = exceed, outdo.

Q2. D) confirms

Frequent citation in other publications shows (confirms) that Tenenbaum's work is relevant. "Misrepresents" is negative; "anticipates" means foresees; "eclipses" means overshadows—none fit the logical meaning.

Q3. B) equivocal

The passage states some studies support the empathy effect while others don't. "Equivocal" means ambiguous or open to multiple interpretations—exactly describing mixed, inconclusive results.

Q4. D) prescient

Jacobs's 1961 arguments continue to shape debates decades later. "Prescient" means having foresight, anticipating future developments—her ideas proved ahead of their time. "Ephemeral" (short-lived) is the opposite.

Q5. A) It qualifies the comparison by specifying a key structural difference.

The previous sentence compares siphonophore signaling to vertebrate neural communication. The underlined sentence then clarifies that the resemblance is only superficial: zooids lack synapses and use a different mechanism. This qualifies (adds nuance to) the comparison.

Q6. D) It introduces a counterargument before the text presents Ribeiro's response.

Other archaeologists raise the alternative explanation of parallel development. Ribeiro then responds with clay-composition evidence. The sentence functions as a counterargument that the text addresses.

Q7. B) Elite institutions can serve as equalizers, partially offsetting cultural capital advantages.

Text 2 shows low-income students at elite universities earned incomes matching wealthier peers. This suggests institutions can reduce inequality regardless of social background—partially offsetting the cultural capital advantages Bourdieu describes in Text 1.

Q8. A) Children acquire language at a pace significantly faster than other forms of learning.

Pinker emphasizes "remarkable speed" of acquisition; Tomasello also studies how quickly children learn words in joint attention. Both would agree children learn language unusually fast, even if they disagree on the mechanism. B, C, and D are either too extreme or contradicted by one author.

Q9. D) The city intensifies rather than resolves his internal conflict.

David expected Paris to "dissolve" his uncertainties but instead found they were "compressed into a tighter space." Every interaction reminded him of what he was carrying. The city amplified his conflict rather than easing it.

Q10. B) Records that document enslaved people's presence but fundamentally fail to represent their humanity.

Hartman says the documents "simultaneously preserve and erase"—they confirm existence while stripping individuals of interiority and voice. This matches B: they document presence but fail to represent humanity.

Q11. A) During the 1990s tech boom, economic growth exceeded capital returns for nearly a decade.

Summers argues rapid technological innovation can cause growth to outpace capital returns. If data from the 1990s tech boom confirms this happened, it directly supports his objection to Piketty's claim that capital returns always dominate.

Q12. C) Patients produced the correct activation pattern when asked to signal yes or no to factual questions.

The skeptic says activation could be automatic rather than intentional. If patients could use different imagined activities to answer specific questions correctly, this demonstrates deliberate, conscious choice—not automatic response.

Q13. B) Park A (smallest) had a higher Simpson diversity index than Park D (largest).

Patel hypothesized both metrics would increase with area. Species richness did increase, but the Simpson index did not follow the same pattern: Park A (2.1 ha) has an index of 0.89 while Park D (42.0 ha) has 0.72. This shows diversity index

doesn't simply scale with area.

Q14. B) was active

"The collective" is a singular noun (even though it refers to multiple painters). Singular subjects take singular verbs: "was active." The context (early twentieth-century) requires past tense.

Q15. D) continent; because

Two independent-clause-level ideas are connected: Thompson has extracted cores from every continent / these cores contain records. A semicolon joins them, and "because" begins the explanatory clause. A comma before "because" would create a comma splice with the complex sentence structure.

Q16. A) itself,

The main clause describes what Fleming noticed. The phrase beginning with 'an observation that...' is an appositive providing additional information. A comma after 'itself' correctly sets off this nonrestrictive appositive.

Q17. D) that would flood the interior with natural light,

The list uses parallel structure: 'a cantilevered entrance that would extend...', 'a glass atrium that would flood...', and 'a rooftop garden accessible....' Option D maintains the parallel 'that would + verb' structure matching the first item.

Q18. A) Analyzing satellite imagery from 2010 to 2020,

The modifying phrase must have its subject as "the research team" (who did the analyzing). Only A correctly attaches the participial phrase to the team. B, C, and D create dangling or misplaced modifiers.

Q19. C) Beyond these two categories,

The previous sentences define labor and work. Arendt then identifies a third category: action. "Beyond these two categories" signals the introduction of something additional to what was already discussed.

Q20. B) Complicating this narrative,

The conventional view was that the asteroid alone caused the extinction. Keller's evidence of volcanic eruptions contributing to the event adds complexity to (complicates) that simple narrative without entirely overturning it.

Q21. D) In his view,

The sentence presents Acemoglu's specific argument about what happens with extractive institutions. "In his view" attributes this claim to Acemoglu and provides the contrast with inclusive institutions. "Conversely" would also work logically but "In his view" better introduces the elaboration of his argument.

Q22. B) While Goffman focused on adapting behavior to audiences, Butler's theory addresses how repeated actions construct gender itself.

The goal is to highlight a difference. B identifies the key distinction: Goffman examined role-switching across contexts, while Butler specifically theorizes how repetition creates the category of gender. A and D emphasize similarities instead.

Q23. C) By preserving earliest biblical manuscripts alongside unknown texts, the Scrolls have reshaped scholarly understanding of ancient Jewish life.

The goal is scholarly significance. C captures both what the scrolls contain (biblical + non-biblical texts) and their impact (fundamentally reshaping understanding). A and D lack the significance claim; B focuses only on dating.

Q24. B) Lovelace is credited as the first programmer because her 1843 notes contained an algorithm for machine execution.

The goal is to explain WHY she's considered the first programmer. B provides the causal reasoning: her notes included the first algorithm written for a machine (computing Bernoulli numbers). The other options state facts but don't explain the 'why.'

Q25. D) recursion may not be as uniquely human as Chomsky has argued.

If tamarins can recognize recursive patterns, then recursion might not be exclusive to humans—which would challenge Chomsky's claim that recursion is uniquely human. B is too extreme; C reverses the comparison; A contradicts the finding.

Q26. A) be more reluctant to sell than economic theory predicts, because selling converts an unrealized loss into a definitive one.

Loss aversion means losses hurt more than equivalent gains feel good. Selling a declining stock makes the loss "real." An investor would resist this psychological pain by holding the stock longer than rational analysis suggests—the classic disposition effect.

Q27. B) which

"Which" introduces a nonrestrictive relative clause modifying "photographs" (things, not people). "Who" is for people; "that" would typically be restrictive; "whom" is an object pronoun and doesn't work as a subject here.

Section 2: Math — Module 1

Q1. B) 22

$p(x) = -24 - 7x = -178$. Solving: $-7x = -178 + 24 = -154$. $x = -154 / -7 = 22$.

Q2. A) $11x^2 - 55$

Distribute: $11(x^2 - 5) = 11x^2 - 11(5) = 11x^2 - 55$.

Q3. A) A lamp running for 9 hours has a predicted brightness of 400 lumens.

$g(9) = 400$ means when $x = 9$ (hours running), $g(x) = 400$ (lumens). So after 9 hours, brightness is predicted to be 400 lumens.

Q4. B) $47/72$

Probability = favorable outcomes / total outcomes = $47/72$.

Q5. 845

Reading from the table: altitude 1,500 m, digital barometer column = 845 hPa.

Q6. D) $8n \geq 2,400$

Each candle sells for \$8, need at least \$2,400. Revenue = $8n$. Inequality: $8n \geq 2,400$.

Q7. B) 8

With 14 children, $3.5a + 4(14) = 84$. Thus $3.5a + 56 = 84$, so $3.5a = 28$ and $a = 8$.

Q8. D) -11

The left side $-(5x - 3)^2$ is always less than or equal to 0. For no real solution, $q + 12$ must be positive, so $q > -12$. The least integer satisfying this is -11.

Q9. C) 55

A dilation preserves angle measures. Since angle P is 55 degrees and corresponds to angle S, angle S is also 55 degrees.

Q10. C) 325π

Circumference = $2\pi r = 10\pi$, so $r = 5$. Volume = $\pi r^2 h = \pi(25)(13) = 325\pi$.

Q11. C) 26

Area = $(1/2)(\text{base})(\text{height})$. Thus $156 = (1/2)(12)h = 6h$, giving $h = 26$.

Q12. B) 25

For angle y , the opposite leg is 25 and the adjacent leg is 24. Thus $\tan(y) = 25/24 = c/24$, so $c = 25$. Answer: B) 25.

Q13. C) $f(-3) = 0$

If $(-3, 0)$ is an x -intercept, then $f(-3) = 0$ by definition. An x -intercept is a point where $y = f(x) = 0$.

Q14. 8 or 12

$(x - 12)(x - 8)(x + 5)(x + 14) = 0$ gives $x = 12, 8, -5$, or -14 . The positive solutions are 8 and 12, so either 8 or 12 is accepted.

Q15. 55

Reading from the table: 30-mile delivery costs \$55.

Q16. 6**Q17. 3**

$4(x-3) = (x-3) + 9$. Let $u = x-3$: $4u = u + 9 \rightarrow 3u = 9 \rightarrow u = 3$. So $x - 3 = 3$.

Q18. C) 55

Subtracting the equations gives $x = 3$. Substituting yields $y = 7$. Therefore, $(13/3)x + 6y = 13 + 42 = 55$.

Q19. B) 7

$m(2) = 18(3^{-2}) + 5 = 18(1/9) + 5 = 7$.

Q20. $55/3$ or 18.33

Slope = $(11-0)/(2-5) = 11/(-3) = -11/3$. Using point $(5,0)$: $y = (-11/3)(x-5)$. At $x = 0$: $y = (-11/3)(0-5) = (-11/3)(-5) = 55/3 \approx 18.33$.

Q21. -4

From table: slope = $(34-22)/(0-(-3)) = 12/3 = 4$. Equation: $y = 4x + 34$, or $-4x + y = 34$. So $A = -4$, $B = 1$. $A/B = -4$.

Q22. A) $(r, -3r/7 + 2)$

The second equation is 3 times the first ($9x + 21y = 3(3x + 7y) = 3(14) = 42$). So the system has infinitely many solutions along $3x + 7y = 14$. Solving for y : $y = (14 - 3x)/7 = -3x/7 + 2$. If $x = r$: $y = -3r/7 + 2$. Point: $(r, -3r/7 + 2)$.

Section 2: Math — Module 2 Easier

Q1. C) 270

$$600 \times 0.45 = 270 \text{ feet.}$$

Q2. A) 4,687.5

From 1800 to 1900 there are five 20-year doubling periods. Therefore, the 1800 population was $150,000 / 2^5 = 150,000/32 = 4,687.5$.

Q3. B) 15

$$\text{Mean} = (2+5+8+12+18+45)/6 = 90/6 = 15.$$

Q4. D) $k(x) = (1/3)x$

$$k(0) = 0 \text{ and } k(9) = 3. \text{ Slope} = (3-0)/(9-0) = 1/3. \text{ y-intercept} = 0. \text{ So } k(x) = (1/3)x.$$

Q5. A) $2m + 2n = 56$

$$\text{Perimeter of rectangle} = 2(\text{length}) + 2(\text{width}) = 2m + 2n = 56.$$

Q6. B) Exactly one

$$5x - 23 = 23 - 5x \rightarrow 10x = 46 \rightarrow x = 4.6. \text{ One solution.}$$

Q7. D) -10

$$y = 48 > 22 \checkmark. 3x + 48 < 25 \rightarrow 3x < -23 \rightarrow x < -7.67. \text{ Among choices, only } -10 < -7.67.$$

Q8. B) $g(x) = 40x$

$$\text{Slope} = (560-240)/(14-6) = 320/8 = 40. g(6) = 240: 40(6) = 240 \checkmark. \text{ y-intercept: } 240 - 40(6) = 0. \text{ So } g(x) = 40x.$$

Q9. D) $-3x^2 + 3x - 4 = 0$

Use the discriminant $b^2 - 4ac$. Choice D has $a = -3$, $b = 3$, $c = -4$, so the discriminant is $9 - 4(-3)(-4) = -39 < 0$. Therefore, D has no real solutions.

Q10. A) (0, 81)

$$y = 9^{x+2}. \text{ At } x=0: y = 9^{(0+2)} = 9^2 = 81. \text{ y-intercept: } (0, 81).$$

Q11. D) 4,200

$$35 \text{ pages/min} \times 60 \text{ min/hr} \times 2 \text{ hr} = 35 \times 120 = 4,200 \text{ pages.}$$

Q12. 160

$$15(280) + 7c = 5,320 \rightarrow 4,200 + 7c = 5,320 \rightarrow 7c = 1,120 \rightarrow c = 160.$$

Q13. A) 28

Using $y = x^2 - 20x + 28$ together with $y - x = 28$ gives $x^2 - 21x = 0$, so $x = 0$ or 21 . The corresponding y -values are 28 and 49. Thus 28 is a possible value, so A is correct.

Q14. 12

$$c(r) = (3/7)(2\pi r) = (6/7)\pi r. \text{ When } r \text{ increases by } 14: c(r+14) - c(r) = (6/7)\pi(14) = 12\pi. \text{ So } k = 12.$$

Q15. A) 25

$$f(x) = 30(1.25)^{x/4}. \text{ When } x \text{ increases by } 4: f(x+4)/f(x) = 1.25. \text{ That's a 25\% increase. So } p = 25.$$

Q16. 49

$\sqrt{48p + 49} = p$. Square both sides: $48p + 49 = p^2$. $p^2 - 48p - 49 = 0 \rightarrow (p - 49)(p + 1) = 0$. $p = 49$ or $p = -1$. Since p must make the square root valid and positive, $p = 49$.

Q17. 9

$121x^2 + 110x + 25 = (11x + 5)^2$. Given $121x^2 = -110x + 56$: $121x^2 + 110x = 56$. So $(11x + 5)^2 - 25 = 56 \rightarrow (11x + 5)^2 = 81 \rightarrow 11x + 5 = \pm 9$. Since $11x + 5 > 0$: $11x + 5 = 9$.

Q18. D) $M = 10(3.20)^{(t/3)}$

A 220% increase means multiplication by 3.20 every 3 hours. At $t = 12$ there are four growth periods, and $10(3.20)^4 = 1,048.576$. Therefore, D is the model that matches the given data.

Q19. A) 71.50%

Start with value V . After +145%: $V \times 2.45$. After -30%: $2.45V \times 0.70 = 1.715V$. Net increase: 71.5%.

Q20. $-1/8$

$m^{(3/8)} = k^{(1/2)} \rightarrow k = m^{(3/4)}$. $m^{(2a+1)} = k = m^{(3/4)} \rightarrow 2a + 1 = 3/4 \rightarrow 2a = -1/4 \rightarrow a = -1/8$.

Q21. $4/3$

Right triangle LMN: $LN = 36$ (hypotenuse), $LM = 27$. By similar triangles with altitude ME to hypotenuse: $MN/ME = LN/LM = 36/27 = 4/3$.

Q22. D) 0.43

$280 \text{ ft}^2/\text{hr} \div 60 \text{ min/hr} = 4.667 \text{ ft}^2/\text{min}$. Convert to m^2 : $1 \text{ ft} = 1/3.28 \text{ m} = 0.3049 \text{ m}$. $1 \text{ ft}^2 = 0.0929 \text{ m}^2$. $4.667 \times 0.0929 \approx 0.4335 \text{ m}^2/\text{min}$. Answer: **D) 0.43**.

Section 2: Math — Module 2 Harder

Q1. C) 420

$$1,200 \times 0.35 = 420 \text{ boxes.}$$

Q2. C) 14

$$\text{Mean} = (3+6+9+11+14+41)/6 = 84/6 = 14.$$

Q3. A) $w(x) = (4/7)x$

$$w(0) = 0, w(7) = 4. \text{ Slope} = 4/7. \text{ y-intercept} = 0. w(x) = (4/7)x.$$

Q4. B) 55

$$\text{Vertex form: } f(x) = -(x-6)^2 + 49. \text{ Vertex at } (6, 49). h + k = 6 + 49 = 55.$$

Q5. A) (27/5, 22/5)

From $x - y = 1$, $x = y + 1$. Substitute into $2x + 3y = 24$: $2(y + 1) + 3y = 24$, so $5y = 22$ and $y = 22/5$. Then $x = 27/5$. Therefore, A is correct.

Q6. C) $(x - 3)^2 + (y + 5)^2 = 49$

$$\text{Circle equation: } (x-h)^2 + (y-k)^2 = r^2. \text{ Center } (3, -5), \text{ radius } 7: (x-3)^2 + (y+5)^2 = 49.$$

Q7. A) $9x^2 - 16$

$$\text{Difference of squares: } (3x+4)(3x-4) = (3x)^2 - 4^2 = 9x^2 - 16.$$

Q8. A) 43.6

$$m = 2.8(20) - 12.4 = 56 - 12.4 = 43.6 \text{ grams.}$$

Q9. B) 13

$$5(x-4) = 3(x+2) \rightarrow 5x - 20 = 3x + 6 \rightarrow 2x = 26 \rightarrow x = 13.$$

Q10. B) 9

$$x^2 + 14x + 58 = (x+7)^2 + 58 - 49 = (x+7)^2 + 9. \text{ So } a = 7, b = 9.$$

Q11. 13

$$|3x - 15| = 24. \text{ Case 1: } 3x - 15 = 24 \rightarrow x = 13. \text{ Case 2: } 3x - 15 = -24 \rightarrow x = -3. \text{ Positive solution: } 13.$$

Q12. 25.0

$$\cos(37^\circ) = 20/\text{hyp} \rightarrow \text{hyp} = 20/\cos(37^\circ) \approx 20/0.7986 \approx 25.0.$$

Q13. C) 2

$$\text{Set equal: } x^2 - 6x + 5 = -x + 5 \rightarrow x^2 - 5x = 0 \rightarrow x(x - 5) = 0 \rightarrow x = 0 \text{ or } x = 5. \text{ Two solutions.}$$

Q14. 7

$$4^x = 64 = 4^3, \text{ so } x = 3. 3^y = 81 = 3^4, \text{ so } y = 4. \text{ Therefore, } x + y = 7.$$

Q15. C) 20π

$$\text{Sector area} = (\theta/360)\pi r^2 = (72/360)\pi(100) = (1/5)(100\pi) = 20\pi.$$

Q16. 121

$$f(4) = 2(4) + 3 = 11. g(4) = f(4)^2 = 11^2 = 121.$$

Q17. A) 28

$$2.5 \text{ standard deviations from mean: } 50 \pm 2.5(8) = 50 \pm 20. \text{ Range: } 30 \text{ to } 70. \text{ Values outside this range: } 28 < 30. \text{ Answer: A) } 28.$$

Q18. 19

$$(x^2 - 25)/(x + 5) = (x+5)(x-5)/(x+5) = x - 5 = 14. \text{ So } x = 19.$$

Q19. C) 3/4

Line $4x + 3y = 12$ has slope $-4/3$. Perpendicular slope = negative reciprocal = $3/4$.

Q20. $x + 1$

$p(x) = x^3 - 5x^2 + 3x + 9$. Since $p(3) = 0$, divide by $(x-3)$: $x^3 - 5x^2 + 3x + 9 = (x-3)(x^2 - 2x - 3) = (x-3)(x-3)(x+1)$. Other factor: $(x + 1)$.

Q21. B) Randomly assign plots to receive fertilizer or not, then compare yields.

Random assignment is the hallmark of a controlled experiment, which is the only design that can establish causation. Observational studies and surveys can only show correlation.

Q22. A) 6

Substitute $y = x + 2$ into $x^2 + y^2 = 100$: $x^2 + (x+2)^2 = 100 \rightarrow x^2 + x^2 + 4x + 4 = 100 \rightarrow 2x^2 + 4x - 96 = 0 \rightarrow x^2 + 2x - 48 = 0 \rightarrow (x+8)(x-6) = 0$. Since $x > 0$: $x = 6$.

End of Answer Key. These answers correspond to the 100% original DSAT practice test DSAT_Dec_2024_US_1-W. Not affiliated with or sourced from College Board, ETS, or any official SAT materials.